



User generated content

UGC spans everything generated by users in the digital world. Everything from discussion boards, blogs, wikis, social networking sites, Q&A



databases, news sites, journals, photos, videos, et al, all of those exabytes of data lying on servers around the world are user generated. It usually stems from a desire to express oneself; it is the social incentive, some form of catharsis that people look forward to when they create content. It is one of the things that defines Web 2.0, and levels the playing field – as users also generate content, rather than just being passive consumers.



IRC

A precursor to the modern day chat, IRC (Internet Relay

Chat) was one of the most extensively used protocols for chatting. Even today, the top 100 IRC networks serve more than half a million users at a time. IRC was actually propelled into the spotlight during the gulf war in 1991. During this period information was relayed in real-time from around the world. After 2001 though, IRC saw its popularity decline, as other forms of chatting and filesharing took preference. However, all of the wise old hackers and a lot of the current day script kiddies still haunt the IRC networks. A good place to meet famous hackers, or to pick up a virus or two.



Crowd sourcing

A portmanteau of 'crowd' and

'outsourcing' it was coined by Jeff Howe in a Wired Magazine article "The Rise of Crowdsourcing", where he reasoned that the with the availability of latest technological advancements at low cost has decreased the disparity between professionals and amateurs, and thus companies can take advantage of talents of the public and get their work done at the same time. Not just companies; governments, civil services, schools, colleges and other such organisations can harness the power of Crowdsourcing. One of the best examples of cloud sourcing is Wikipedia. It remains to be seen whether crowdsourced initiatives can be financially viable – it looks bleak though, if Wikipedia's pleas for donations are anything to go by.



VoIP

VoIP (pronounced voyp) is perhaps a relatively old

technology. However, it's one of the more important technologies in use today. Thanks to Skype and also your local ISP providing VoIP at dirt cheap rates, making calls all around the world was never easier and cheaper. In fact, even in India, as broadband penetration increases at a rapid rate, we're starting to see more and more options for dedicated hardware devices that use VoIP to make calls. It's the perfect way to connect our villages to the rest of the world, because of the cheap running costs.



Zuckerberged!

This guy doesn't warrant any introduction, a blockbuster Hollywood flick has done the needful.



This Harvard drop-out, started Facebook, the world's largest social networking web site from his college dorm room and is currently valued at 4.27 billion USD. Apart from serving his iconic responsibilities, Zuckerberg is responsible for setting the overall direction and product strategy for Facebook. He also leads the development team that works on Facebook's core technology and infrastructure. The rest of the time he is busy updating his pet's Facebook profile. Lambasted left, right and centre for his stand on privacy and almost continuous changes in the UI, which Facebook seems to change like snake's skin. But with 800 million active users across the globe, Zuckerberg and Facebook will be here for good.



E-commerce

E-commerce tends to send you back to the good old days when the dot-com bubble had just started growing; Pepsi and Internet Cafes had started becoming a rage; like every one else we too are going retro. Though there is nothing retro about e-commerce, it is perhaps driving force behind the Internet today and most pertinent among all the discussions on Web. This is what enables companies that populate Internet to earn billions of dollars annually. Of course, e-commerce is not just about buying and selling products online, it is also about sourcing, marketing, supplying and providing post-sales support. With innovative new approaches such as group buying, and same day delivery (which Amazon plans to bring to India) e-commerce is all set to kill retail for good.

Google



A synonym for search, its something that has been embedded into our zeitgeist.

Google has come a long way from its early days as search engine, to an ever burgeoning producer of massively successful products. But it seems to be consolidating now closing down many of the projects that didn't quite



catch on. It also provides B2B solutions - Google App Engine which offers Google's own infrastructure to run your websites on. Google too caught on the social networking bug starting with Orkut, then Buzz and culminating in Google+. And then there was Android, followed by the coup-de-etat of buying out Motorola for a cool \$12 billion dollars. It's currently the leading smart-phone OS in the world with nearly half of the world's smart phones running Android. A company with a great sense of humor and keen idea about what exactly its users want, it is here to stay.

2,095,006,005

Estimated number of people across the world that use the Internet